Staff answers & diagnostic guide — Surface texture skills lab

Pathway: BASE · Week 3 Part 2 · Big question: How can we use foil and dry brush marks to make card look like old metal?

Starter answer & explanation

Question: Why do we wipe most of the paint off the brush on a paper towel. First dry brushing?

Correct: So paint only touches the high ridges and leaves the gaps dark — Yes. A dry brush skims the top bumps and keeps the deep lines dark.

Guided team check (We do) answers

Q1: What happens if you press foil on a hard table with a sharp point instead of a foam mat and blunt stick? -> The foil rips instead of making smooth raised bumps (Yes. The soft foam under lets the foil stretch into neat bumps.)

Q2: How hard should you press when dragging a dry brush over ridged card? -> Feather-light, skimming just the top bumps (Yes. Light strokes catch the ridges and leave dark shadows in the grooves.)

Q3: How do we mount our finished foil square so the raised bumps do not get squashed flat? -> Put glue only around the flat outside edge and press the border gently (Yes. Touching only the border keeps the middle bumps raised.)

Exit check answer

Question: Why do we put a soft foam mat under craft foil when we press lines?

Correct: So the foil stretches into raised bumps without ripping — Yes. The soft mat lets the blunt stick push neat grooves into the foil.